

"NOBODY HAS LEFT NDA BECAUSE OF OUR PERFORMANCE. IT WAS BECAUSE OF THEIR OWN ISSUES... IF THEY COME TO US, WE DON'T MIND IT"

about chemistry.' And we have better chemistry with the people. Our chemistry won, and we got 64 Lok Sabha seats. Next time, we'll get more. Let the Opposition meet, they have every right to do so. As for outcomes, if you have taken the wrong route, how will you ever reach the right destination?

Q. When you say 'wrong path', what do you mean?

Tell me what kind of unity is this? There is only one unity—that of taking care of their family interests. The Maha Vikas Aghadi in Maharashtra, what were they doing except to take care of their family interests? Akhilesh Yadav is taking care of his own family interests, Omar (Abdullah) is looking after his own interests, (Mehbooba) Mufti is doing the same, Uddhav (Thackeray) is protecting his son Aditya, Stalin his son Udayanidhi—all of them are protecting the interests of their respective families. Even Pawar sahib... he is trying to save his daughter. And the Congress... Rahul Gandhi. I usually say that this is a party of the mother, son and the daughter; everyone else is on contract.

Q. So they are not a threat to you?

I say that anybody who has to take on the BJP has to first work for 45 years. If you walk on that path, you will reach our level.

Q. In Bihar, the JD(U) joined the *Mahagathbandhan* with the RJD and ditched the BJP last year. Recently, the CBI sent a notice to Lalu Prasad Yadav and Tejashwi of the RJD in a case that's around 15-20 years old. It seems the BJP is targeting them.

Not at all. From the very first, our stand is that anyone who is accused of corruption would not be let go of easily. So, action is taking place. Our strategy in Bihar is that we will take developmental and good social work forward and move ahead.

Q. The charge against the BJP is that wherever Opposition parties are strong, it unleashes the central agencies like the CBI and ED in those states.

This is a democratic country. If the Opposition thinks there's any wrongdoing on the part of the BJP leaders, they should complain to the ED or other bodies. If after that the central agencies don't take any action, then you should cry foul.

Q. In West Bengal, Mamata Banerjee seems to hold her own.

In 2024, the BJP will increase its seat tally in West Bengal.

Q. Even after the TMC swept the recent civil polls?

Each election is different. Even this civic election proved one thing—wherever there was proper police deployment and the law-and-order situation remained under control, the BJP came out a winner.

Q. The BJP seems to want to revive the NDA after it had lost a lot of allies.

First, nobody has left NDA because of our performance. It was because of their own issues. We were never against them at that point in time; we are not against them at this point in time. We are not reaching out to them. If they come to